

	Data	Total	Year to
Company Name	Date	Return	100
Hollyfrontier Corp	10/31/66	12,279	21.2
Franklin Resources Inc	12/31/81	11,363	4.2
Forest Laboratories – CL A	12/31/72	7,874	11.5
TJX Companies Inc	10/31/62	6,946	28.5
Southwest Airlines	12/31/71	5,478	9.5
Newmarket Corp	12/31/62	5,077	22.8

Berkshire is in a category by itself, and we'll look at it in more detail in chapter 9.

Kansas City Southern is a railroad stock. It's up more than 16,000-fold since 1974. A \$10,000 investment there turned into \$160 million in 40 years. I would never have guessed a railroad stock would top the list. The second stock on the list is an oil-and-gas firm that now is mainly a refiner. It's a 14,000-bagger.

Some of the other names are not so surprising. Walmart and McDonald's are stocks you probably could've guessed. And remember, this is just the top.

There are 365 stocks that have met our 100-bagger threshold since 1962.

The 100-bagger population seems to favor no particular industry.

There are retailers, beverage makers, food processors, tech firms and many other kinds. The only thing they seem to have in common is the subject of the study: they returned at least 100 to 1.

It's also worth considering the size of these companies when they started their march. Now I hesitate to make generalizations from the statistics, as I've said. And that's why my focus is more on anecdotal evidence and the ideas or theories behind 100-baggers. With that warning, I'll add that the median sales figure for the 365 names at the start was about \$170 million and the median market cap was about \$500 million.

That's interesting on two levels: One, it dispels a myth that to get a 100-bagger you have to start with tiny companies. True, these are small companies. But \$170 million in sales is a substantial business in any era.

It's not a tiny 50-cent stock with no revenues or barely any